

Currently, this drive is the fastest-performing among all competing drives, and also provides a 5-year warranty—not to mention its next-gen SATA-2 specification. The price? Approximately \$220 (Rs 9,700) for a 400 GB drive.

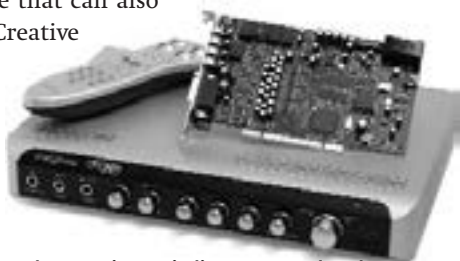
The Optical Drive

Optical drives are a necessity that you cannot ignore. And we're not talking about just any CD or DVD writing drive—we are referring to the Lite-On SHW-16H5S LightScribe. Why this drive? Firstly, it belongs to the Lite-On family of drives that have a reputation of building robust and affordable drives with excellent error correction capabilities, and also provide a vast set of features including automatic speed adjust for less noise and vibration, dual-layer dual-format support with writing speeds of up to 8X and, of course, LightScribe. Lightscribe is a special writing process where specially made recordable CD and DVD media can be labelled using a LightScribe DVD recorder. Remember, you need to have both the media and the drive which support LightScribe, otherwise it is useless.

The Audio Card

When it comes to the ideal gaming rig, there is one and only one audio card right now—the Creative Labs X-Fi Elite Pro, also the worldwide rage right now. Retailing at Rs 22,000 or so, this card is more expensive than the Creative Megaworks 550D set of 5.1 speakers.

But hey, this baby rocks! The high-end DACs, guitar input, and music creation apps make the Elite Pro a juicy option for any gamer. Plus the remote that can also be used with select Creative speakers, and the break-in board that has a host of connectivity options for you to play with. Did we mention the onboard 64 MB X-RAM? That



The Creative X-Fi Elite Pro Soundcard